



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National Police College of Jamaica Department of Weapons and Tactical Training less
Lethal Weapons Standard Operating Procedures

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Less Lethal Standard Operating Procedures

Introduction

The term 'less-lethal options' is employed to indicate weapons, devices, and tactics, the design, and intention of which, is to induce compliance in pursuit of a legitimate aim by the police without a substantial risk of serious or permanent injury or death to the subject on whom they are applied. In other words, the desired effect is to control and then neutralize a threat without recourse to lethal use of force. Whilst the actual outcome may, on occasions, be lethal, this is less likely than as the result of the use of firearms.

It is necessary to ensure that any force used is proportionate to the seriousness of the apparent threat, and appropriate options in this area assist adherence to that principle.

Members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force are trained and equipped with various types of weapons and ammunition that would allow for a differentiated use of force and firearms. These include less-lethal weapons for use inappropriate situations.

In addition to firearms, officers are trained and issued with batons and incapacitating chemical sprays, tasers, and a restraining device (handcuffs).

Scope

Less lethal Standard Operating Procedure is designed to target sworn and sworn members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force. These groups include Trainee Constables/ Recruits, serving members, and other government entities.

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to outline the operations and guidelines of Less Lethal/ Defensive Tactics Training in the Jamaica Constabulary Force.

Authority

The Less Lethal Training Team is a part of the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training (DWTT), which is an independent department and reports directly to the Director of the National Police College of Jamaica who gives the authority for all Less Lethal Training.

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Less Lethal Training

For any member to conduct Less Lethal Training he/she must be a certified Less Lethal Instructor who was certified an authorized entity approved by the Jamaica Constabulary Force. The current Less Lethal training was conducted by the Safariland Group approved by the JCF. Any other entity conducting Less Lethal Training, that member/ members must also be under the supervision of a certified Less Lethal Trainer from the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training who is responsible for training in the JCF.

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A Less Lethal Instructor should possess qualities to include but not be limited to tolerance, patience, and good communication skills.

Less Lethal Training Admission

Members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force is admitted to Less Lethal Training through two major channels:

- As a part of Basic Training (at least four to six (4-6) weeks after enlistment in the JCF.
- Whilst as a serving member-based upon needs analysis will be selected to complete the training.

Documentation/Registration

All participant that is trained in Less Lethal Training is registered in the Less Lethal Register where the member will sign on completion of the training and if in receipt of ant less-lethal equipment.

All assessments and tests paper completed are handed over to the Administration office at the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training.

The final evaluation form is completed by the instructional staff and submitted through the DWTT administration office to the Faculty of Recruit and Probationary Training to be placed on the students' files.

Serving members' documentation is filed in the Administration Office at DWTT for future reference.

Course duration

Less Lethal Training Course for Trainee Constables duration is for 40 hours. During this time several techniques, skills, and attitudes are imparted.

Briefing and debriefing

Less Lethal Training begins at 9:00 am with a briefing and tasking session for instructors. The participants are mustered and briefed for each activity. During the muster, the participants are inspected to ensure that their attire and grooming are in keeping with the policies and guidelines of the organization.

At the end of the day's activities, both participants and instructors are debriefed separately.

Assessments

There are four assessments given to the two sectors of persons doing Less Lethal Training,

- Safe Encounter Assessment: this is a practical assessment done to reproduce contact and cover techniques and search techniques.
- Handcuff Assessment: this is a practical assessment to demonstrate handcuffing techniques taught.

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- Test one (1): this comprises of questions from Human Rights and Use of Force Policy, Safe Encounter theory.
- Test two (2): this comprises of questions from Handcuffing theory, Baton Techniques theory, and Oleoresin Capsicum theory.

If in the eventuality a student fails any of these assessments, a remedial lesson is given then a resit where the minimum pass score is recorded. Participants need to acquire 60 % of the total score of each test to be successful.

Response to injuries during training.

At the start of each course, an inquiry is done to ascertain if any member has any pre-existing injury. If a member indicates that he/ she has such injury, a basic assessment is done to acquire if that individual will be able to complete the course successfully. This is done by my certified Less Lethal instructor.

If whilst in the process of the training a member sustains an injury, it should be immediately reported to the Sub-officer on the ground and the member be afforded first aid treatment. For more serious or complicated injuries the member will be transported to the Medical Services Branch or the nearest hospital.

A follow-up assessment is done with the participant to ascertain if the injury is prolonged and the advice from the Medical Service Branch is adhered to.

A report is submitted to the Sub-officer in charge of the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training explaining the circumstances in which the member was injured.

To mitigate against certain injuries members are brought through a warm-up session for half an hour before any physical activities.

Dress Code

Trainee Constables

Constables in training will be required to wear Defensive Tactics gear. This comprises black or dark blue T-shirts, shorts (steel draws), and sneakers. Sneakers are worn for defensive tactics training as it aids in the maneuvering of movements as is more comfortable.

Whilst in Less Lethal Training black or blue T-shirt, pants and combat boots. This dress code helps the students to transition into work mode as this is closest to the uniform structure.

Serving members

Regular members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force are required to wear their full Denim attire for Less Lethal Training.

Training Content

Lectures

All Participant who is in attendance for a Less Lethal Course must be lectured in the following areas:

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- Human Rights
- Use of Force and Firearm Policy
- Safe Encounter
- Search
- Baton
- Handcuff
- Oleoresin Capsicum (OC pepper spray)

The lecture on equipment is inclusive of the care (maintenance) and safe use.

Practical sessions

- Safe Encounter: contact and cover, search, handcuff
- Baton: strikes and defenses
- Oleoresin Capsicum: target practice and simulation

Training aids and resources

- Classroom
- Whiteboard
- Flip chart
- Projector
- Laptop
- Igloo
- Video clippings
- Baton
- Handcuff/ handcuff keys
- Oc pepper spray
- Training mats
- Training batons

Participants need to acquire a minimum score of 60 % on both theory and practical assessments to be successful. At the conclusion, each participant will be issued with less lethal kit consisting of: utility belt, belt keepers, pepper spray and pouch, handcuff and pouch.